



Nigerian Midstream and Downstream
Petroleum Regulatory Authority

General Counsel and Legal Advisers Forum

Theme:

Beyond Compliance.

Driving Regulatory Certainty and Investment
Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector



29th - 30th June, 2026

9am Daily



Ladi Kwali Conference Centre,
Abuja Continental Hotel,
FCT-Abuja

Programme of Events



National Anthem

I
Nigeria, we hail thee,
Our own dear native land,
Though tribe and tongue may differ,
In brotherhood we stand
Nigerians all,
And proud to serve our sovereign Motherland.

II
Our flag shall be a symbol
That truth and justice reign,
In peace or battle honoured,
And this we count as gain,
To hand on to our children
A banner without stain.

III
O God of all creation,
Grant this our one request:
Help us to build a nation
Where no man is oppressed,
And so with peace and plenty
Nigeria may be blessed.



NIGERIAN MIDSTREAM AND
DOWNSTREAM PETROLEUM
REGULATORY AUTHORITY

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02.



HIS EXCELLENCY,
BOLA AHMED TINUBU, GCFR.

PRESIDENT, COMMANDER-IN-CHIEF OF THE ARMED FORCES
FEDERAL REPUBLIC OF NIGERIA



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DOWNSTREAM PETROLEUM
REGULATORY AUTHORITY

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SEN. HEINEKEN LOKPOBIRI, PhD.

HONOURABLE MINISTER OF STATE FOR PETROLEUM RESOURCES (OIL)
FEDERAL REPUBLIC OF NIGERIA



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DOWNSTREAM PETROLEUM
REGULATORY AUTHORITY

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RT. HON. EKPERIKPE EKPO

HONOURABLE MINISTER OF STATE FOR PETROLEUM RESOURCES (GAS)
FEDERAL REPUBLIC OF NIGERIA



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DOWNSTREAM PETROLEUM
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MALLAM RABIU ABDULLAHI UMAR

AUTHORITY CHIEF EXECUTIVE
NIGERIAN MIDSTREAM AND DOWNSTREAM PETROLEUM REGULATORY AUTHORITY



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NMDPRA EXECUTIVE MANAGEMENT



ABIODUN A. ADENIJI
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
FINANCE & ACCOUNTS



OGBUGO K. UKOHA
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
DISTRIBUTION SYSTEMS, STORAGE &
RETAILING INFRASTRUCTURE



FRANCIS A. OGAREE
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
HYDROCARBON PROCESSING PLANTS, INSTALLATIONS
AND TRANSPORTATION INFRASTRUCTURE



OLUWOLE ADAMA
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
MIDSTREAM AND DOWNSTREAM
GAS INFRASTRUCTURE FUND



BASHIR A. SADIQ
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
CORPORATE SERVICES & ADMINISTRATION



DR. ZAINAB GOBIR
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
ECONOMIC REGULATIONS AND STRATEGIC PLANNING



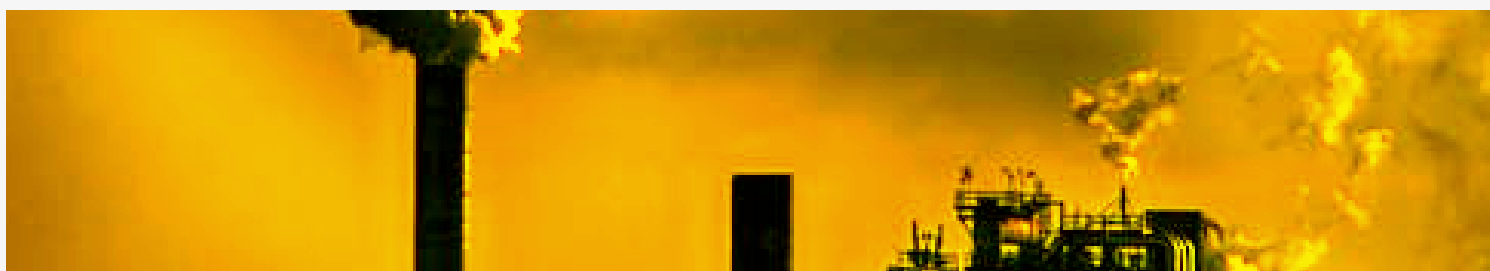
DR. MUSTAPHA LAMORDE
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
HEALTH, SAFETY, ENVIRONMENT
AND COMMUNITY



DR. JOSEPH TOLORUNSE
AUTHORITY SECRETARY/LEGAL ADVISER



About The Event



The NMDPRA General Counsel and Legal Advisers Forum is the flagship industry engagement initiative of the Nigerian Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Regulatory Authority, designed to engage directly with chief legal officers, general counsels, and in-house legal teams of licensed operators. The Forum serves as a strategic platform for regulatory dialogue, policy clarification, and collaborative problem-solving between the Authority and the legal leadership responsible for ensuring compliance and guiding operational decisions within the petroleum industry.

Against the backdrop of a rapidly evolving post-PIA regulatory framework, the Forum offers participants a high-level opportunity to engage directly with the NMDPRA on areas of legal ambiguity, implementation challenges, and shared compliance responsibilities. It serves not only as a knowledge exchange platform but also as a regulatory feedback mechanism to strengthen mutual understanding between the

Authority and the legal leadership of licensed entities. The Authority believes that sustained engagement at this level is vital for building trust, improving regulatory clarity, and reinforcing the legal foundations of a transparent, accountable, and investor-friendly petroleum industry.

This year's edition is convened under the theme "Beyond Compliance: Driving Regulatory Certainty and Investment Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector", and will build on the foundation of the 2025 edition which succeeded in establishing compliance as a shared value between the NMDPRA and the legal leadership of licensed operators.

Participants will leave the Forum better equipped to interpret regulatory expectations, guide internal compliance strategy, and engage more confidently with the Authority in resolving legal and operational issues.



Programme of Events

Date: Monday, 29th to Tuesday, 30th June 2026.
Time: 9am – 4pm daily
Venue: Ballroom 4, Ladi Kwali Conference Centre,
Abuja Continental Hotel

Theme:
Beyond Compliance: Driving Regulatory Certainty
and Investment Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector

DAY 01

MON, 29TH JUNE

1	Registration and Accreditation of Participants	Registration Desk	8:30 – 9:30
2	Arrival of Guests/Preliminary Introductions	Compere	9:30 – 10:00
3	National Anthem	Compere	10:05 – 10:10
4	Safety Brief	Abuja Continental Hotel	10:10 – 10:15
5	Opening Remarks & Welcome Address by the Authority Chief Executive, NMDPRA	Mallam Rabi'u Abdullahi Umar	10:15 – 10:25
6	Keynote Address by the Honourable Minister of State for Petroleum Resources (Oil) on the Forum theme	H.E. Senator Heineken Lokpobiri, Ph.D	10:25 – 10:50
7	Group Photograph with the Authority Chief Executive, and other VIPs		10:50 – 11:00
8	Presentation by Authority Secretary and Legal Adviser, NMDPRA on – “Beyond Compliance: Driving Regulatory Certainty and Investment Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector”	Dr. Joseph Tolorunse	11:00 – 11:10
9	Session 1 (Opening Panel) – “Beyond Compliance: Driving Regulatory Certainty and Investment Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector”	Moderator – Dr. Ayodele Oni (Partner, Bloomfield LP) Panelists – - Dr. Joseph Tolorunse (Authority Secretary and Legal Adviser, NMDPRA) - Ijeoma Idika (Head, Legal & Regulatory Compliance, Falcon Corporation) - Okezi Okah-Avae (General Counsel, Tetracore Energy) - Tolulope Fadipe (General Counsel, Sahara Energy Group)	11:10 – 12:10



10	Tea Break		12:10 - 12:40
11	Presentation by the Special Assistant to the President on Petroleum on – “Unlocking Investor Confidence: Rethinking Institutional Interfaces and Enabling Policies in Nigeria’s Petroleum Sector”	Ola Adeniji	12:40 - 12:50
12	Session 2 (High Level Government Panel) – “Unlocking Investor Confidence: Rethinking Institutional Interfaces and Enabling Policies in Nigeria’s Petroleum Sector”	Moderator – - Adebayo Ologe (Lead Partner, May & Ivory) Panelists – - Mallam Bashir Sadiq (Executive Director, Corporate Services and Administration, NMDPRA) - Olayemi Adeboyejo (Commission Secretary and Legal Adviser, NUPRC) - Dr. Simeon Obidairo (General Counsel, Nigeria Revenue Service) - Terlumun George-Maria Tyendezwa (Director, Legal Services, Ministry of Petroleum Resources) - Ola Adeniji (Special Assistant to the President on Petroleum)	12:50 - 13:50
13	Presentation by the Senior Partner, Primera Africa Legal on – “From Policy to Project: Exploring Legal and Commercial Entry Points for Investment in Nigeria’s Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Value Chain”	Boma Alabi, OON SAN	13:50 - 14:00
14	Session 3 (Investment Panel) Panel Discussion on – “From Policy to Project: Exploring Legal and Commercial Entry Points for Investment in Nigeria’s Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Value Chain”	Moderator – - Gideon Sado (Managing Partner, Deon LP) Panelists – - Oluwole Adama (Executive Director, Midstream and Downstream Gas Infrastructure Fund, NMDPRA) - Boma Alabi, OON SAN (Senior Partner, Primera Africa Legal) - Ikechukwu Ekwueme (Vice President Legal and Company Secretary, Renaissance Africa Energy Company Ltd) - John Chibueze (General Counsel, AXXELA Group)	14:00 - 15:00
15	Interactive Session/Q&A/Wrap-up	Dr. Charles Nwachukwu (Coordinator, Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Alternative Disputes Resolution Centre, NMDPRA)	15:00 - 15:30
16	Lunch and Closing		15:30 - 16:30
17	Authority Chief Executive’s Welcome Cocktail		18:00 - 20:00



DAY 02

TUES, 30TH JUNE

1	National Anthem	Compere	10:05 - 10:10
2	Safety Brief	Abuja Continental Hotel	10:10 - 10:15
3	Recap of Day 1 Activities and Outlook for Day 2 by Regulatory Affairs Lead, Atom Energy Law Advisory	Fortune Toma	10:15 - 10:25
4	Presentation by Executive Director, Distribution Systems, Storage and Retailing Infrastructure, NMDPRA on – “Energy Security: Understanding The Issues.”	Mr. O. K. Ukoha	10:25 - 10:35
5	Session 4 (Downstream Session) Panel Discussion on – “Energy Security: Understanding The Issues.”	Moderator – Dr. Emeka Akabogu, SAN (Senior Partner, Akabogu and Associates) Panelists – - Mr. O. K. Ukoha (Executive Director, Distribution Systems, Storage and Retailing Infrastructure, NMDPRA) - Adaeze Nwakoby (GM GRC, NNPC Retail Ltd) - Hafsat M. Ambursa (Executive Director, Commercial, AYM SHAFA Ltd) - David Edet (General Counsel, Eterna Plc)	10:35 - 11:35
6	Tea Break		11:35 - 12:05
7	Presentation by Vice President, Government Relations at Chappal Energies Offshore Ltd on — “Advancing Nigeria’s Midstream Potential: Legal, Regulatory and Commercial Imperatives in transportation, refining and processing”	Adekunle Adegun	12:05 - 12:25



8	Session 5 (Midstream Session) Panel Discussion on – "Advancing Nigeria's Midstream Potential: Legal, Regulatory and Commercial Imperatives in transportation, refining and processing"	Moderator – - Olabode Sowunmi (CEO, Cabtree Ltd) Panelists – - Engr Francis Ogaree (Executive Director, Hydrocarbon Processing Plants Installations, and Transportation Infrastructure, NMDPRA) - Adekunle Adegun (Vice President, Government Relations at Chappal Energies Offshore Ltd) - Ngozi Efobi (General Counsel, Greenville LNG) - Oluwadare Agbelese (Group Head, Legal and SCM, Waltersmith Refinery)	12:25 - 13:25
9	Presentation by the Executive Director, Health, Safety, Environment and Community, NMDPRA on – "From Mandate to Impact: Implementing the PIA's Host Community Development Framework Across Nigeria's Midstream Petroleum Value Chain"	Dr. Mustapha Lamorde	13:25 - 13:35
10	Session 6 (Closing Panel) Panel Discussion on – "From Mandate to Impact: Implementing the PIA's Host Community Development Framework Across Nigeria's Midstream Petroleum Value Chain"	Moderator – Munachiso Michael (Senior Associate, Templars) Panelists – - Dr. Mustapha Lamorde (Executive Director, Health, Safety, Environment and Community, NMDPRA) - Humphrey Onyeukwu (Group Head, Legal & Company Secretary, Oilserv Ltd) - Chinemerem Ikechi-Eshiet (Company Secretary, Pipeline Infrastructure Nigeria Ltd) - Uche Nwamara (General Counsel, Midwestern Oil and Gas Ltd)	13:35 - 14:35
11	Interactive Session/Q&A/Wrap-up	Dr. Charles Nwachukwu (Coordinator, Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Alternative Disputes Resolution Centre, NMDPRA)	14:35 - 15:00
12	Lunch and Closing		15:00 – 16:00



Speakers Bios





Mr. O. K. Ukoha

Executive Director, Distribution Systems,
Storage and Retailing Infrastructure,
NMDPRA

Speakers Bios

Ogbugo Ukoha's twenty-six [26] years career began in PPMC/NNPC and spans Petroleum regulation, Law practice across the broad energy value chain in multiple jurisdictions and board level executive management experience. He has led and supported organizations through strategic turn-around (Mergers, Planning & Execution).

His current role as NMDPRA's Executive Director, Distribution Systems, Storage and Retailing Infrastructure puts him in charge of the technical/commercial regulation of the petroleum downstream industry in Nigeria and he has consequently evolved as a leading subject matter expert.

Ogbugo is currently focused on enabling Nigeria's transition to gas, driving industry automation, diversifying distribution infrastructure and operationalizing the National Strategic Stock. He chairs the NMDPRA Stakeholder engagements that have resulted in the gazetting of sixteen (16) NMDPRA regulations in compliance with the Petroleum Industry Act.



Engr Francis Ogaree

Executive Director, Hydrocarbon
Processing Plants Installations, and
Transportation Infrastructure, NMDPRA

Speakers Bios

Engr. Francis Ogaree graduated in 1980 from the University of Lagos and held several Project Manager positions across a number of organisations for over a decade, before joining NNPC in 1992, where he occupied various strategic positions, including roles at NAPIMS, a Corporate Strategic Unit of NNPC, and as Technical Assistant to the GGM, Operations, acquiring vast experience in economic evaluation and project monitoring within the petroleum industry. At NNPC Headquarters, he served as Manager, Brass LNG Project, and later General Manager (Commercial), Renewable Energy Division.

In recognition of his excellent performance, he was appointed Senior Technical Assistant to the Honourable Minister of State, Energy (Petroleum), from 2007 to January 2009, before being redeployed to NNPC as General Manager (International Venture Opportunities), with responsibility for consolidating upstream assets outside Nigeria. He retired voluntarily from NNPC in 2013 and joined West African Ventures (WAV), an oil and gas service company, as Managing Director, before leaving in 2014 to become Chief Operations Officer at PAI International, an engineering consulting firm. In 2015, he established ISO-DATEK MULTI-CONCEPT, an oil and gas consultancy specialising in training, procurement, and project management.

Upon the passage of the Petroleum Industry Act in 2021 and the creation of the Nigerian Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Regulatory Authority (NMDPRA), Engr. Ogaree's professionalism, dedication, and quality of work earned him appointment by the President and Commander-in-Chief as Executive Director, Hydrocarbon Processing Plants, Installations and Transportation Infrastructure (HPPITI), a position he currently holds. He holds a B.Sc. in Civil Engineering from the University of Lagos (1980) and an M.Sc. in Construction Management (1990) from Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria, and has attended numerous intensive training programmes and executive courses, alongside several write-ups and presentations on topical issues spanning the upstream, midstream, and downstream segments of the oil and gas industry.





Mallam Bashir Sadiq

Executive Director, Corporate Services
and Administration, NMDPRA

Speakers Bios

Mr. Sadiq joined the services of the Nigerian National Petroleum Corporation's Inspectorate Division in late 1987, having been recruited from the famed Petroleum Training Institute, Effurun, Delta State, while still a student, based on the recommendation of his departmental head. When the NNPC Inspectorate transitioned to the Department of Petroleum Resources (DPR), he continued his service and worked in every section and unit of the DPR's Downstream Division at both field office and headquarters levels. His tenacity and hard work were recognised by successive managements of the Department, enabling him to rise through the ranks, without skipping a single grade level, to the most senior position in the Downstream Division as Deputy Director and Head, Downstream Monitoring and Regulation.

Mr. Sadiq is one of the key players behind the transformation of the defunct DPR's downstream processes into the more efficient and transparent digitised processes that earned the Department accolades across the Nigerian oil and gas industry. He also built a first-class regulatory team within the Downstream SBU that blazed the trail in service delivery, marked by the fastest facilities licensing turnaround time in the history of the Department.

Mr. Sadiq holds a Master's Degree in Environmental Resources Management from the Lagos State University, a Post Graduate Diploma in Industrial Chemistry from Abubakar Tafawa Balewa University, Bauchi, a Final Diploma in Chemistry/Biochemistry from the University of Jos, and a PTI Diploma from the Petroleum Training Institute, Effurun. He has also attended numerous professional development courses both within and outside Nigeria.



Dr. Mustapha Lamorde

Executive Director, Health, Safety,
Environment and Community, NMDPRA

Speakers Bios

Dr. Mustapha Lamorde is a distinguished oil and gas and energy sector professional with over two decades of local and international experience spanning petroleum engineering, energy regulation, strategic business development, corporate leadership, and policy advisory. He serves as the Executive Director Health, Safety, Environment & Community (HSEC) of the Nigerian Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Regulatory Authority (NMDPRA), where he leads the regulation of health, safety, environmental sustainability, and community related aspects of Nigeria's midstream and downstream petroleum operations. He also represents the NMDPRA on the Board of the Nigerian Upstream Petroleum Regulatory Commission (NUPRC), bringing a wealth of technical expertise, regulatory insight, and executive leadership to the Commission's oversight of Nigeria's upstream petroleum sector.

Prior to joining the NMDPRA, Dr. Lamorde worked with Shell as a Petroleum Engineer for over a decade, contributing to exploration, drilling, field development, production management, and deepwater operations across multiple international locations. He founded Fossils Global Solutions Limited, where he served as Managing Director/CEO, driving strategic growth and investments within the oil and gas industry. He also served as an independent consultant and advisor on policy, regulatory, commercial, and operational matters across the energy sector. Dr. Lamorde began his professional career with Geoservices International as a Drilling Data Engineer in the UK North Sea.

Dr. Lamorde holds a Ph.D. in Petroleum Engineering from Heriot-Watt University, United Kingdom, and has attended several advanced technical, leadership, and executive management programmes. He is a Chartered Engineer (C.Eng.) registered with the UK Engineering Council (UKEC), a Registered Engineer (R.Engr.) with the Council for the Regulation of Engineering in Nigeria (COREN), and a Chartered Petroleum Engineer with the Energy Institute (EI), United Kingdom. He is equally a member of the Nigerian Society of Engineers (NSE), the Society of Petroleum Engineers (SPE) and Fellow Nigerian Institute of Petroleum and Gas Engineers (NIPetE).





Oluwole Adama Oladapo

Executive Director, Midstream and Downstream Gas Infrastructure Fund, NMDPRA

Speakers Bios

Oluwole Adama Oladapo is a seasoned professional in the downstream oil and gas sector, with over 25 years of experience spanning leadership roles in Total Nigeria Plc, NNPC Retail Limited, and his current position as Executive Director of the Midstream and Downstream Gas Infrastructure Fund (MDGIF).

Throughout his career, he has consistently demonstrated excellence in operations, strategy, and retail management. While at Total Nigeria Plc, he received multiple accolades, including the prestigious Best Retail Sales Executive Award in 1999, 2000, and 2003. His exceptional performance earned him a place in the Young Manager Executive Training Program in Paris in 2001.

Mr. Adama holds a Bachelor's degree in Banking and Finance from Ondo State University, Ado-Ekiti (1993), an MBA in Marketing from the University of Lagos (2000), and a Master's degree in Managerial Psychology from the University of Ibadan (2004).



Dr. Joseph Tolorunse

Authority Secretary and Legal Adviser, NMDPRA

Speakers Bios

Dr. Joseph Tolorunse, PhD, is an accomplished legal expert with over three decades of experience in Nigeria's energy sector. He currently serves as Authority Secretary/Legal Adviser to the Board of the Nigerian Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Regulatory Authority (NMDPRA). Prior to NMDPRA, he served as Legal Adviser/Ag. Secretary to the Board of the Nigerian Upstream Petroleum Regulatory Commission (NUPRC) and Head of Compliance & Enforcement, where he coordinated, supervised, and drafted several key regulations that strengthened the stability, efficiency, and transparency of Nigeria's energy market.

Dr. Tolorunse's foundational experience includes a 27-year tenure at the defunct Department of Petroleum Resources (DPR). He served on the inter-agency committee on the Petroleum Industry Act and the National Action Committee's Oil and Gas Sub-Committee on the review of the African Continental Free Trade Agreement (AfCFTA), as well as Secretary to the Top Management Committee of the defunct DPR and Secretary/Legal Adviser to the Advisory Councils on the National Data Repository and the Oil and Gas Dispute Resolution Centre at NOGEC, Lagos. Academically, he holds multiple advanced degrees in law and international diplomacy, including a Doctor of Philosophy in Petroleum Law and Policy from the Centre for Energy, Petroleum and Mineral Law and Policy, University of Dundee, Scotland.

Dr. Tolorunse is a member of several professional organisations, including the Nigerian Bar Association (NBA), the International Bar Association (IBA), the Association of International Petroleum Negotiators, and the Institute of Chartered Secretaries and Administrators (ICSAN), and is a Fellow of the International Dispute Resolution Institute. He has received numerous accolades recognising his leadership and technical expertise, which continue to shape Nigeria's petroleum industry and inspire the next generation of legal professionals.





Olayemi Adeboyejo

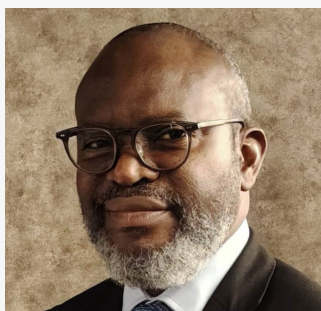
Commission Secretary and
Legal Adviser, NUPRC

Speakers Bios

Olayemi Adeboyejo is the Commission Secretary and Legal Adviser of the Nigerian Upstream Petroleum Regulatory Commission (NUPRC), where she provides strategic legal counsel to the Commission and its Governing Board. She is widely regarded as one of Nigeria's leading energy lawyers, bringing three decades of distinguished experience across private practice, the energy industry and public sector regulation. She graduated as the Best Overall Graduating Student in Law from the University of Ibadan and obtained an LL.M. in Corporate and Commercial Law from the University of Cambridge as both a Chevening and Pegasus Scholar. She recently completed the Advanced Management Program (AMP) at the Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania, further strengthening her expertise in executive leadership and public sector transformation.

Before joining the Commission, Olayemi founded Sefton Fross, served as Senior Partner at Templars, and was General Counsel of Sahara Energy Group. Throughout her career, she has advised governments, multinational energy companies, financial institutions and investors on complex petroleum, infrastructure, finance and commercial transactions. She has held several leadership positions within the legal profession, including Regional Representative (Africa) of the International Bar Association's Power Law Committee and Chair of the Nigerian Bar Association's Mergers and Acquisitions Committee. She also contributed to regulatory reform initiatives through the National Assembly Business Environment Roundtable (NASSBER).

An internationally recognised practitioner, Olayemi has been recognised by Chambers Global, Legal 500, IFLR1000, Who's Who Legal and other leading legal directories. She has also been listed among Nigeria's Top 100 Leading Women and Top 20 Female Lawyers. She is a published author and co-author of chapters in the Encyclopedia of Upstream Oil and Gas (2019 and 2023). As Commission Secretary and Legal Adviser, she plays a central role in the implementation of the Petroleum Industry Act, providing strategic legal counsel on upstream petroleum regulation, governance, investment, commercial transactions and institutional reform.



Terlumun George-Maria Tyendezwa

Director, Legal Services, Ministry of
Petroleum Resources

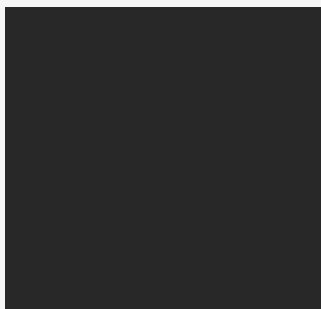
Speakers Bios

Mr. Tyendezwa graduated from Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria, where he obtained an LL.B. (Hons) in 1997, and was called to the Nigerian Bar in September 1999. An acclaimed legal practitioner, international cyber-diplomat, and certified digital forensics expert with nearly three decades of experience, he currently serves as Director (Legal Services) of the Ministry of Petroleum Resources, having previously served in the same capacity at the National Environmental Standards and Regulations Enforcement Agency.

A globally recognised authority on cybercrime and digital infrastructure policy, as well as ESG, he serves as Vice-Chair of the Ad Hoc Committee on Cybercrime, established pursuant to GA Resolution A/RES/74/247, which elaborated the UN Convention Against Cybercrime adopted on 24 December 2024. He was also the pioneer Secretary of the Cybercrime Advisory Council (2016–2020), amongst other roles.

He is a NAGTRI International Fellow on Cybercrime (2013) and an alumnus of the George C. Marshall European Center for Security Studies, the International Anti-Corruption Academy (IACA), and the Tallinn Cyber Diplomacy School.





Dr. Simeon Obidairo

General Counsel,
Nigeria Revenue Service

Speakers Bios

Dr. Simeon Obidairo is a distinguished legal, governance, and regulatory expert. He currently serves as General Counsel to the Executive Chairman of the Nigerian Revenue Service (NRS).

His extensive international experience includes senior advisory and counsel roles with the African Development Bank, World Bank Group, World Health Organization, and the United Nations, focusing on regulatory reform, enforcement frameworks, and anti-corruption investigations. He was Partner and Head of Governance, Compliance and Investigations at Aluko & Oyebode.

Dr. Simeon Obidairo holds a PhD in International Corporate and Criminal Law from SOAS, University of London, and is qualified to practice law in Nigeria and New York, USA. He has deep expertise in legal advisory services, regulatory governance, and institutional compliance relevant to strengthening accountability frameworks within Nigeria's regulatory ecosystem. He is also a fellow at SOAS University of London and teaches classes on corruption and corporate criminal law.



Dr. Charles Nwachukwu

Coordinator, Midstream and Downstream
Alternative Disputes Resolution Centre,
NMDPRA

Speakers Bios

Dr. Charles Nwachukwu is an accomplished legal professional and regulatory expert with over 26 years of experience primarily within Nigeria's energy sector, spanning roles in the upstream, midstream, and downstream petroleum sectors, where he has made significant contributions to policy formulation, stakeholder engagement, and the resolution of complex industry disputes. He is currently the Coordinator of the Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Alternative Dispute Resolution Centre.

As Head of Subsidiary Legislation Development and Stakeholder Engagement at the NMDPRA, his work has focused on drafting and deploying several regulations governing petroleum licensing, fiscal policies, and operational compliance that balance the interests of government, the private sector, and other key stakeholders, while also fostering productive relationships between the regulator and industry operators. Before joining NMDPRA, Dr. Nwachukwu held strategic positions at the Nigerian Upstream Petroleum Regulatory Commission (NUPRC) and the defunct Department of Petroleum Resources (DPR). At the NUPRC, he served as Senior Technical Assistant to the Head of Compliance and Enforcement and as Team Lead for Compliance and Enforcement, spearheading the implementation of compliance strategies and regulatory policies aligned with the Petroleum Industry Act (PIA) 2021, with a view to further stabilising Nigeria's upstream petroleum operations.

Charles holds several advanced legal degrees and certifications from globally acclaimed institutions on International Trade, petroleum contracts, fiscal systems, corporate governance, public-private partnerships (PPP), and asset divestment, among others. He is a certified mediator and holds membership in several national and international professional bodies.





Ola Adeniji

Special Assistant to the
President on Petroleum

Speakers Bios

Ola Adeniji is an energy policy and legal professional working at the intersection of energy law, public policy, and investment. She currently serves as Special Assistant to the President on Petroleum in the Office of the Special Adviser to the President on Energy, where she supports the design and implementation of reforms across Nigeria's oil, gas, and power sectors.

In this role, she has contributed to some of Nigeria's most consequential energy sector reforms, including initiatives aimed at improving competitiveness, strengthening regulatory certainty, resolving legacy sector challenges, and attracting investment. These reforms have supported over US\$10 billion in upstream oil and gas investments and helped position Nigeria as Africa's leading destination for upstream capital investment for two consecutive years.

Ola holds a law degree from the University of Warwick. She is passionate about the role of energy in driving economic development, industrialisation, and prosperity across Africa, and is a strong advocate for women's empowerment and increased female participation in leadership across the energy sector.



Dr. Ayodele Oni

Partner, Bloomfield LP

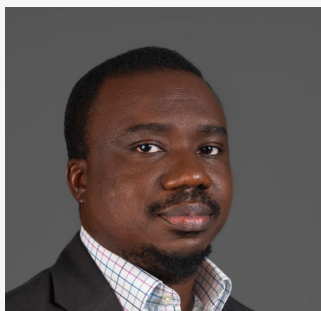
Speakers Bios

Ayodele Oni provides excellent and commercially savvy legal solutions across Nigeria's petroleum value chain, with particular strength in midstream and downstream oil and gas, refining and pipeline infrastructure, gas processing and distribution, project financing, acquisitions, and corporate restructuring, with a knack for creating ingenious and effective strategies that give investors and counterparties the certainty and confidence to commit capital, even within complex and evolving regulatory environments. He is an active leading voice and thought leader in the development of many of the transformative policy and regulatory changes that have reshaped Nigeria's energy sector, having played key roles in developing the template documents, rules, and regulations used in the natural gas and electric power sectors, work that goes to the very heart of the regulatory certainty on which investment confidence is built. Since the enactment of the Petroleum Industry Act 2021, he has advised clients on navigating the midstream and downstream regulatory framework introduced under the Act and administered by the Authority.

Ayodele has been actively involved in several major oil and gas transactions, including the Shell divestment deals and Chevron's divestment of interests in a number of oil mining leases, and has advised, and continues to advise, on numerous marginal field transactions, including the 2020 marginal fields bid round, and on a wide range of oil and gas acquisition, divestment, and financing transactions. He maintains a seat at the table in the negotiation of almost all major energy sector transactions in Nigeria and remains central to the negotiation of energy infrastructure, including refining and pipeline projects, and the financing transactions that underpin them, across the country.

On the regulatory and institutional side, Ayodele was part of the team that provided legal advisory to the Bureau of Public Enterprises on the post-privatisation restructuring of the electric power sector, has provided legal, policy, and regulatory support to the Nigerian Electricity Regulatory Commission, and has advised the World Bank on power sector issues, giving him a practical, regulator's-eye view of how clear and predictable rules translate into sustained investor confidence. Recognised as being "in a league of his own" by the internationally renowned directory Who's Who Legal, he is also ranked among the world's leading lawyers by Chambers and Partners and The Legal 500, noted for "excellent service," described as "responsive and valuable," and commended for a "keen work ethic and an unyielding commitment to quality." He is an adjunct lecturer and the author of leading energy texts.





Okezi Okah-Avae

General Counsel,
Tetracore Energy

Speakers Bios

Okezi Okah-Avae has over twelve (12) years in the energy sector which has covered infrastructure and project finance, corporate restructuring, investment banking, PE, M&As. He has a Master's Degree in Oil & Gas Law from the University of Aberdeen. Okezi is currently an Executive Director and the General Counsel at Tetracore Energy Group Limited.

Okezi provided legal advisory and compliance guidance to Tetracore in the development and ongoing operation of its 25MMSCFD PNG City Gate facility in Edo State, the 6.2 MMSCFD CNG mother station in Ogun State and the 5MMSCFD CNG Mother station in Ghana. He secured the permits and licenses for the 20MW IPP in Ogun State. He was previously the Company Secretary at QSL Gand Power Ltd, where he secured the first Gas Shippers License issued by NMDPRA and effectively operationalized the Nigerian Gas Transportation Network Code in 2020.

Okezi was a part of the World Bank-funded Power Sector Recovery Program (PSRP) in 2017 where he acted as a legal consultant. Following his stint with the PSRP, he was a Senior Legal Counsel with NNPC Gas Infrastructure Company Limited and NNPC Gas Marketing Limited from 2017 to December 2019. Okezi was awarded the Nigerian Rising Star Award and named one of the Top 40 Lawyers in Nigeria Under Age 40 in 2018. In 2025, he was awarded the Icon of Corporate Law Award and named on the GC Powerlist: Nigeria 2026 by Legal 500.



Ijeoma Idika

Head, Legal & Regulatory Compliance,
Falcon Corporation

Speakers Bios

Ijeoma Idika is often described as a “dedicated, resourceful energy commercial lawyer, policy advocate and strategic business enabler”. She is currently the Head, Legal, Regulatory and Compliance at Falcon Corporation Limited and has over 23 years' experience in legal advisory, energy (with a strong bias in the gas value chain), regulatory compliance, policy formulation and advocacy, financial transaction advisory and corporate governance. She has initiated and managed complex project contracting portfolios, negotiated high stakes financing within the oil and gas value chain for both upstream and downstream businesses; pioneered, coordinated and has been part of cross-function teams on trade financing facility arrangements and has extensively supported private sector public formulation and advocacy towards enhancing gas trading, distribution, utilization and infrastructure development.

She is a Solicitor and Advocate of the Supreme Court of Nigeria, obtained her Bachelor of Laws degree from Abia State University Uturu, and holds an LLM degree from the University of Salford, Manchester, England in International Commercial Law. She is also a certified Associate of Institute of Chartered Secretaries and Administrators of Nigeria and a member of the Nigeria Bar Association; Association of Corporate Counsel, World Commerce and Contracting and African Corporate & Government Counsel Community.

She is also a peer-community leader of a women's group and offers. She is a wife and a mother and spends her free time rendering neighbourhood vocational services, free advisory services to identified MSMEs and start-ups and spending time with her family.





Tolulope Fadipe

General Counsel,
Sahara Energy Group

Speakers Bios

Tolulope Fadipe is a seasoned legal practitioner with over two decades of experience spanning the banking and financial services, oil and gas, and energy sectors. He joined Sahara Group in 2019 and currently serves as General Counsel/Head, Group Legal, a role in which he oversees and coordinates the legal affairs of the Group across its operations in 42 countries spanning Africa, the Middle East, Europe, and Asia, providing strategic legal advisory and support to the Group's various business units and affiliated entities, with responsibility for legal risk management, corporate governance, regulatory compliance, transactions, and dispute resolution across multiple jurisdictions.

He commenced his professional legal career with IBTC Chartered Bank Plc, now Stanbic IBTC Bank Plc, before joining Guaranty Trust Bank Plc (GTBank), where he held various leadership roles within the Legal Department, including Company Secretary/Head, Legal of GTBank Gambia Limited, advising over the course of his banking career on complex financing, corporate, regulatory, and dispute resolution matters and contributing significantly to the management of legal and commercial risks.

Mr. Fadipe holds a Bachelor of Laws (LL.B) degree from the University of Lagos, and was subsequently called to the Nigerian Bar. He also holds a Master of Business Administration (MBA) with Distinction from Obafemi Awolowo University and a Master of Laws (LL.M) from the University of South Wales, United Kingdom, and is a Graduate of the Institute of Chartered Secretaries and Administrators (ICSA), London, and an Associate of its Nigerian arm.



Adebayo Ologe

Lead Partner,
May & Ivory Partners

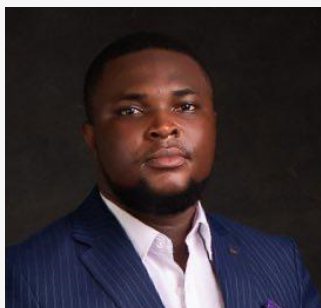
Speakers Bios

Adebayo, whose enduring passion for law influenced his choice of academic pursuit, is a seasoned dispute resolution specialist with over two decades of experience. In addition to his responsibility for the day-to-day management of May & Ivory, where he is the Founding and Lead Partner, Adebayo coordinates and oversees the activities of the firm's Advocacy and Dispute Resolution Practice Group. He commenced his career as an Associate at a leading litigation firm in Lagos, Nigeria, where he was actively involved in the prosecution of several high-profile cases, before later working at a top Lagos commercial law firm as Senior Associate and Head, Dispute Resolution Practice Group, for almost a decade.

As an experienced dispute resolution specialist across all tiers of courts and tribunals in Nigeria, Adebayo has represented a wide spectrum of clients, ranging from local and international businesses to government agencies and departments, and has successfully acted as both prosecuting and defence counsel in several trial and appellate court cases in Nigeria, particularly in oil and gas. As Founding and Lead Consultant at Primewell Consulting Ltd, he also consults for and facilitates law trainings and workshops, especially in oil and gas, for government agencies and departments as well as private companies.

Adebayo is a graduate of the University of Ilorin, Nigeria, where he obtained his Bachelor of Laws (LL.B) with Second Class (Upper Division), and he attended the Nigerian Law School, Abuja, for his professional training (BL), after which he was called to the Nigerian Bar. He is a Notary Public for Nigeria, an accredited insolvency practitioner in Nigeria, a licensed Nigerian Capital Market Solicitor, a member of the Upstream Petroleum Alternative Dispute Resolution Centre (UPADRC) Body of Neutrals, and a member of the Energy Institute (EI) United Kingdom, the Nigerian Bar Association (NBA), and the International Bar Association (IBA).





Gideon Sado

Managing Partner, Deon LP

Speakers Bios

Gideon Sado is the Managing Partner at Deon LP, where he leads the practice at the forefront of Nigeria's oil and gas and energy sector. He has advised several oil and gas companies on navigating Nigeria's licensing regimes across the upstream, midstream, and downstream segments of the value chain, and he led the firm's team that successfully advised an applicant through the Midstream and Downstream Gas Infrastructure Fund (MDGIF) funding rounds, securing over \$8 million in funding.

Deon LP acts as Company Secretariat to several companies, notably Hiter-Stata Energy Investment Company Limited, a \$100 million gas investment company investing in gas infrastructure across the country.

The firm also serves Stata Power Utility Nigeria Limited and CCETC SUK Power Company Ltd, which operate a gas-to-power energy facility in Sagamu valued at over \$80 million. The firm's advisory work spans some of the most significant gas-to-power transactions in the country.



Boma Alabi, OON SAN

Senior Partner, Primera Africa Legal

Speakers Bios

Boma Alabi, OON, SAN is a Senior Partner of Primera Africa Legal (PAL). She leads PAL's Corporate Governance and Compliance Practice. In addition to being an experienced Arbitrator and accredited Civil and Commercial Mediator, Boma specializes in International Tax Law, Maritime Law, Mergers & Acquisitions, and Capital Market Transactions. She has advised on some of Nigeria's leading commercial deals in a number of sectors including real estate and infrastructure, manufacturing, banking, hospitality, telecommunications, maritime, energy, project funding and development.

She served as the President of the Commonwealth Lawyers Association 2011- 2013, the first and only woman President in the over 50-years history of this association of lawyers from 54 countries, across 7 continents. She was a Council Member of the Board of the Royal Commonwealth Society and also served as the Chairman of the Association of Women Solicitors of England and Wales between 2005/2006. She is a member of the Institute of Directors and the ICC. She served a 3-year term on the Board of ALFA International, an international network of law firms with its headquarters in Chicago. She is currently the Chairman of Shipping Association of Nigeria (SAN) as well as the President of Shipping, Shipping Agencies, Clearing and Forwarding Employers Association (SSACFEA).

In addition, Boma serves as an Independent Non-Executive Director on the Board of ARM Harith, and Cowry Assets Management. She also serves on the Board Committees of ARM Harith Remuneration, Nomination and Governance Committee (RNGC) and ARM Harith Board Audit & Risk Committee (BARC). She is on the Board of Cowry Asset Investment, F&GP Committee. She is Chairman of Cowry Finance Limited and also serves on the Advisory Board of WISCAR, a not for profit structured mentoring organization.





Ikechukwu Ekwueme

Vice President Legal and Company Secretary,
Renaissance Africa Energy Company Ltd

Speakers Bios

Ikechukwu ("Ike") Ekwueme is an accomplished legal leader with over 27 years of cross-disciplinary experience spanning private practice, global energy operations, corporate governance, and complex commercial advisory. He is a graduate of the University of Nigeria, Nsukka, and was called to the Nigerian Bar in 1998. He is also a Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Purchasing and Supply (MCIPS), UK. His career includes more than two decades with Shell, rising to General Counsel through multiple senior international roles, with high-impact assignments spanning Managing Counsel, PSA & JOA, for the North Caspian Operating Company in Kazakhstan, and Managing Counsel, Global Litigation, for Sub-Saharan Africa, across a portfolio covering joint ventures, hydrocarbon unitisation, LNG governance, EPC and major capital projects, cross-border M&A, ethics and compliance, and complex disputes, including arbitration and litigation.

He currently serves as Vice President, Legal and Company Secretary at Renaissance Africa Energy Company Limited, providing strategic legal leadership at the intersection of energy, regulation, governance, and business transformation, and supporting the organisation in navigating complex regulatory landscapes, strengthening governance frameworks, and aligning legal strategy with long-term objectives. Renowned for his strategic clarity, intellectual depth, and commercial sensibility, he integrates legal rigour with forward-looking insight, helping organisations anticipate disruption, manage risk proactively, and position themselves within evolving regulatory and investment environments, with work that has contributed to operational resilience, stakeholder confidence, and sustainable value creation across the energy value chain.

Ike brings a future-focused perspective shaped by global exposure at the intersection of investment, regulation, and dispute resolution, alongside a strong grasp of how technology, ESG imperatives, digital transformation, and evolving regulatory ecosystems are reshaping modern legal practice. His leadership reflects a commitment to building institutional capability, fostering innovation within the profession, and advancing a pragmatic, solutions-oriented approach to complex legal and commercial challenges, while positioning the Nigerian legal community to compete confidently and responsibly in a changing world.



John Chibueze

General Counsel, AXXELA Group

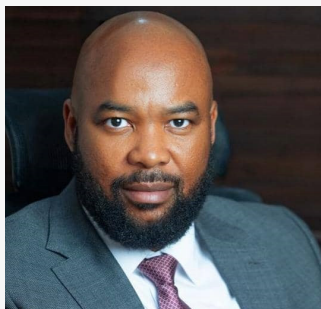
Speakers Bios

John is an internationally recognized energy and infrastructure finance legal counsel with extensive, hands-on experience advising on and overseeing investments, transactions, and projects across Energy (renewable, non-renewable, upstream, midstream, and downstream), Finance (debt, equity, mezzanine), and Commercial transactions.

John has led and steered some of the largest and globally ranked projects and transactions in the African emerging market. Prior to joining Axxela, he was a Partner in the Energy and Project Finance department at the globally leading law firm Dentons-ACAS Law, a Director in a Fortune 500 energy company, and a Deputy General Manager in an international oil and gas company.

John holds an LLB (Hons) from the University of Nigeria, Nsukka, a BL (Hons) from the Nigerian Law School, and an Executive MBA from the London School of Economics and Political Science.





Dr. Emeka Akabogu SAN

Senior Partner, Akabogu and Associates

Speakers Bios

Dr. Emeka Akabogu, SAN is a commercial lawyer widely recognised for his expertise in maritime law and policy in Nigeria. He is the Senior Partner at Akabogu & Associates, a law firm active in shipping, maritime, petroleum, and international trade law, and combines his skills as a transactions and disputes lawyer with deep knowledge of the shipping and petroleum sectors. He holds a law degree from the University of Lagos, an LL.M. from University College London, and Magister Juris and Doctorate degrees from the IMO International Maritime Law Institute, Malta.

Dr. Akabogu was instrumental in developing key legislation in Nigeria's maritime industry, including the Coastal and Inland Shipping (Cabotage) Act 2003, the Marine Environmental Management Regulations 2012, and the Nigerian Stevedoring Regulations 2014. He has succeeded as counsel in landmark shipping and petroleum cases and has trained thousands of operators and practitioners through capacity development initiatives. He has authored "Maritime Cabotage in Nigeria," "Ship Arrest in Nigeria," and "Nigerian Ports Law and Practice," co-edits the "Nigerian Shipping Cases" (Nigeria's longest-running shipping law case compilation), edits the "Journal of Contemporary Nigerian Admiralty Law," and publishes Marine and Petroleum Nigeria. He founded and serves as Vice Chairman of OTL Downstream Development in Africa Ltd./Gte., which organizes the OTL Africa Downstream Energy Week, and is the founder and Convener of the Nigeria International Maritime Summit.

A recipient of numerous industry awards, Dr. Akabogu is a Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Shipping (Nigeria) and a member of the Nigerian Bar Association, Maritime Arbitrators Association of Nigeria, Nigerian Chartered Institute of Arbitrators, and the Energy Institute. He also sits on the Board of Governors of the Centre for Petroleum Information and currently serves as 2nd Vice-President of the Nigerian Maritime Law Association.



Adaeze Nwakoby

GM GRC, NNPC Retail

Speakers Bios

Adaeze is a skilled senior lawyer and chartered company secretary with extensive expertise in the downstream energy sector, both locally and internationally. She currently serves as the General Manager of GRC at NNPC Retail. Previously, Adaeze held the position of Company Secretary and Group Head of Legal & HR at OVH Energy Marketing Limited (formerly Oando Marketing Limited), where she played a pivotal role in managing the company's diverse board and shareholder relationships while providing strategic legal support to business leaders. She also served as Head of Legal for Oando Plc's Downstream Businesses across Nigeria, West Africa, Europe, and the Middle East.

Adaeze holds an LLB from the University of Nigeria, a BL from the Nigerian Law School, and an LLM with distinction in Petroleum Tax and Finance from the University of Dundee (CEPMLP). In addition, she earned an MBA from Warwick Business School in 2021. Her commitment to continuous professional development is demonstrated by her participation in programs facilitated by institutions such as The Oxford Princeton Program (UK), Lagos Business School, and the University of Southampton Institute of Maritime Law. Adaeze has also contributed thought leadership through articles published in several energy industry journals. She is an active member of the Nigerian Bar Association, the Nigerian Institute of Directors, and the Institute of Chartered Secretaries and Administrators.

Adaeze's greatest strengths lie in her ability to execute with precision and deliver meaningful impact. Her success is driven by a relentless pursuit of learning, excellent people management skills, and a keen eye for detail. Her diverse career experiences have honed her strategic thinking and analytical abilities, enabling her to consistently deliver results. Adaeze is deeply motivated by a passion for continuous learning and a commitment to leaving a positive, lasting impact in every endeavor she undertakes.



**NIGERIAN MIDSTREAM AND
DOWNSTREAM PETROLEUM
REGULATORY AUTHORITY**

**General Counsel and
Legal Advisers Forum**

Theme:
Beyond Compliance.
Driving Regulatory Certainty and Investment
Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector



Hafsat M. Ambursa

Executive Director, Commercial, AYM SHAFa Ltd

Speakers Bios

Hafsat M. Ambursa has over 10 years experience in the downstream sector of the Oil & Gas Industry with major specialization in Logistics & Supply Chain Management and Marketing.

She joined A.Y.M. Shafa Holdings Limited in 2018 as the Manager Logistics & Operations and within a short period of time rose to become the Head of Commercial services vested with the responsibility of managing/supervising both the retail and bulk sales segments of the company. She succeeded in restructuring not just her department but also contributed to the Executive Management's drive in restructuring the entire business by putting in place the requisite processes and procedures which guide the business.

Her exceptional performance in turning around the sales volumes of the company and continuous dedication to uplifting the company's position and repute both within and outside the industry is what led to her promotion to the position of Executive Director, Commercial Products, Marketing and Sales. She has won various awards and commendations from the company's leadership. Hafsat is a graduate of the University of Abuja, with a Bsc. in Economics and Msc in Oil & Gas Operations Management from the University of Central Lancashire, Preston United Kingdom with a Distinction.



David Edet

General Counsel, Eterna Plc

Speakers Bios

David Edet is a corporate and commercial lawyer with expertise spanning energy law, dispute resolution, corporate governance, and company secretarial practice. He holds a Bachelor of Laws (LL.B.) degree from the University of Nigeria, Nsukka, and Master of Business Administration (MBA) degrees from Ahmadu Bello University and the Quantic School of Business and Technology.

Over the course of his career, Mr. Edet has acted as counsel in high-stakes litigation before State, Federal, and Appellate Courts across Nigeria, and has served as Tribunal Secretary in several complex and high-value arbitration proceedings conducted under the rules of leading international arbitral institutions, including the London Court of International Arbitration (LCIA) and the Singapore International Arbitration Centre (SIAC). He also sits on the Board of the International Centre for Dispute Resolution (ICDR) Young & International, where he contributes to initiatives focused on the advancement of international dispute resolution practice. He has advised on a broad range of commercial transactions and corporate matters across diverse sectors, including capital markets, oil and gas, shipping and maritime, and manufacturing, with significant experience in corporate governance, regulatory compliance, ESG and sustainability advisory, and stakeholder management, as well as extensive experience engaging with government and regulatory agencies and navigating and resolving the complexities that often arise from such engagements.

In his role as General Counsel and Company Secretary of Eterna PLC, Mr. Edet provides strategic legal and governance advisory support to the Board and executive management, with a strong focus on corporate governance best practices, risk management, ethics and compliance, and ESG integration within corporate decision-making frameworks.





Olabode Sowunmi

CEO, Cabtree Ltd

Speakers Bios

With a Bachelor's Degree in Engineering Physics from Obafemi Awolowo University, where he did research work on "Characteristics of Compound Semiconductors" and "Analysis of Materials Used in Flow Mechanics," Olabode has built a career spanning consulting with KPMG, business and technology research with eShekels Limited, events management with AITEC Africa, freelance writing for Business Day and Guardian Newspapers, and tactical and strategic marketing with Ericsson. He served as a freelance columnist with various papers in the early part of the century, and his experience as a software salesperson has given him unique insight into business development and corporate strategy. He went on to serve as Head of Marketing & Communications for Ericsson (West Africa), overseeing marketing, events, brands, and communications for the company across the region, before moving to Harris-Stratex Communications as Territory Manager. In 2010, he transitioned into the energy industry, beginning with consultancy work to design the framework for an energy publication called Energia Today.

Olabode's energy sector contributions include serving as project manager for a collaboration between the GSM Association (GSMA), the MTN Group, and Ericsson to convert the diesel fuel used in base stations to biofuels, with pilot projects executed in Barcelona, Spain, and Lagos, Nigeria. The project's success led to him being interviewed by a TV station in Catalonia. He also led the team that analysed and advised Nigeria's National Assembly on electricity tariff increases, and currently serves as Consultant to the House Committee on Gas, Senior Legislative Aide to the Senate President on Gas & Power, Vice-Chair of the Gas-to-Power Study Group of the Nigerian Gas Association (NGA), and a member of the Group of Experts on Gas to the United Nations Economic Commission for Europe (UNECE).

Olabode has featured as a guest energy analyst on Money Line with Nancy (AIT), Channels Television, and the South African Broadcasting Corporation (SABC TV), among others, and has been invited as an observer at OPEC meetings as well as a guest of the king's palace at the Ministry of Petroleum in Saudi Arabia. He is a co-owner of the energy consultancy Cabtree Limited and the Publisher of Energia Today, where he also serves as editor-at-large, and has been a member of the African Business Roundtable (ABR) since 2006.



Adekunle Adegun

Vice President, Government Relations,
Chappal Energies Offshore Limited

Speakers Bios

Mr. Adegun has over 33 years' experience in the Oil and Gas Industry with cross functional exposure to Project Finance, Corporate Governance and Ethics, Planning and Strategy, Risk Management, Commercial legal Practice/Contract Negotiations, Management and Board Secretarial Practice.

He left NNPC Limited as General Manager, Commercial covering the NNPC business activities in Upstream, Downstream, Gas, Power, New Energy and Non-Core Business. Post NNPC Limited, Mr. Adegun joined Dangote Industries Limited as Group General Counsel with the responsibility for spearheading the legal team, developing and managing the legal function to support efforts across DIL and its operating entities/business units. He was also responsible for the development of commercial and investment policies and other strategic matters, ethics and compliance within the Group and its operating companies and the management of the Group's company legal secretariat. Post Dangote Industries Limited, he joined Chappal Energies Offshore Limited as Vice president Government Relations.

Mr. Adegun holds a master's degree in resources law and policy from the University of Dundee, Scotland (Centre for Energy, Petroleum and Mineral Law and Policy), BL from the Nigerian Law School and LL. B from Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile Ife. He is a member of the Institute of Directors, Institute of Chartered Secretaries and Administrators, Financial Reporting Council of Nigeria, Nigerian Bar Association, Nigerian Gas Association, International Bar Association and Association of International Energy Negotiators.



**NIGERIAN MIDSTREAM AND
DOWNSTREAM PETROLEUM
REGULATORY AUTHORITY**

**General Counsel and
Legal Advisers Forum**

Theme:
Beyond Compliance.
Driving Regulatory Certainty and Investment
Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector



Ngozi Efobi

General Counsel, Greenville LNG

Speakers Bios

Ngozi Efobi is one of West Africa's active legal minds in energy and infrastructure development, corporate disputes, and project finance. As General Counsel of Greenville LNG Co. Ltd., she is spearheading the legal framework for domestic LNG distribution, modular liquefaction plants, and virtual pipeline networks that are transforming energy access across the region. In this in-house role, she maintains the company's legal framework for West Africa's pioneer integrated virtual LNG pipeline network, connecting several states across Nigeria and beyond, and has created novel security structures addressing currency fluctuation risks in emerging markets alongside revolutionary gas supply agreements enabling industries to transition from fossil fuels to LNG at significant cost savings. She also negotiates and drafts industry-standard, risk-mitigated offtake contracts for small-scale LNG projects, and has developed innovative draft frameworks combining international technology providers with local contractors.

Prior to this role, Ngozi was an Energy Disputes, Transportation and Project Finance Partner at AELEX, a foremost full-service law firm with offices across West Africa, where she was a valued member of the partnership with broad experience across Commercial Litigation, Energy Arbitrations, Project Finance, Company Secretarial, and Regulatory Compliance practice areas. She regularly advised local and international clients on landmark energy deals and arbitrations, including representing clients in multi-million-dollar financing transactions and high-stakes unitisation disputes before the LCIA, and led a landmark effort for an over \$500 million energy infrastructure multi-source financing package blending DFI, commercial debt, and equity investments.

Ngozi was rated as a Rising Star and Leading Individual by the International Financial Law Review (IFLR1000) for eight consecutive years, from 2016 to 2023, in the Project Finance and Capital Markets practice areas, and was named ThisDay Legal Personality of the Week in June 2018. She regularly speaks at webinars and industry events, including recently for the Loan Market Association UK and the Nairobi Centre for International Arbitration.



Oluwadare Agbelese

Group Head, Legal and SCM, Waltersmith Refinery

Speakers Bios

Oluwadare is a legal practitioner with close to 2 decades' post-call professional experience. He is currently the Head of Legal at the Waltersmith Group. He has worked with the energy and corporate commercial teams of two of Nigeria's leading law firms as well as in the legal departments of indigenous and independent exploration and production companies. His specialisations include energy advisory, corporate and commercial advisory (including company secretarial, joint-venture structuring and mergers and acquisitions), and infrastructure-related advisory.

He has been involved in the drafting and review of several key commercial agreements across Waltersmith's upstream and midstream businesses, including the acquisition of 100% interests in PPL 243 (Assa) and the contracting for the Engineering Procurement and Construction of additional capacity for the Waltersmith Modular Refinery. He is also involved in regulatory compliance monitoring and reporting and has ensured adherence to proper corporate governance practices across the board.

He is a graduate of law from the University of Jos and the Nigerian Law School. He also obtained a master's degree in Energy Law and Policy from the Centre for Energy, Petroleum and Mineral Law and Policy, University of Dundee.





Munachiso Michael

Senior Associate, Templars

Speakers Bios

Munachiso Michael is a seasoned legal practitioner with over 16 years of experience spanning dispute resolution, energy and natural resources, corporate commercial, and taxation. He is a Senior Associate at Templars, one of Nigeria's foremost full-service law firms, where he leads the Dispute Resolution practice group in the Abuja office. His oil and gas credentials are extensive, having represented major industry players, including International Oil Companies, in several oil spill disputes and in the landmark \$1.3 billion asset sale dispute involving ExxonMobil, NNPC, and Seplat, as well as representing NNPC in over eleven production sharing contract disputes against international oil companies, from the Federal High Court to the Supreme Court.

He has also contributed to legal advisory work on the OML 40 acquisition and operations, engaged in the proposed re-draft of the Deep Water Block Allocations to Companies (Back-In Rights) Regulations, and actively reviewed and contributed to the Petroleum Industry Bill in its pre-enactment form, providing legal opinions on its implications for industry participants. Beyond litigation, Munachiso has advised on regulatory compliance, banking and finance transactions, and legislative oversight in the energy sector, and contributed as a legal adviser on the N213 billion CBN Nigerian Electricity Market Stabilization Facility.

He holds a Bachelor of Laws from the University of Nigeria, Enugu Campus, where he graduated as the third-best student in his faculty, and was called to the Nigerian Bar with honours. He is an Associate of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators (UK) and a member of the Chartered Institute of Taxation of Nigeria, and is currently pursuing an Executive Master's in Business Administration at Nile University of Nigeria. Munachiso brings to this forum a practitioner's perspective on Nigeria's evolving petroleum regulatory landscape, particularly the obligations and implementation challenges arising under the Petroleum Industry Act 2021.



Humphrey Onyeukwu

Group Head, Legal & Company
Secretary, Oilserv Ltd

Speakers Bios

Humphrey Onyeukwu is a leading energy and infrastructure lawyer with over twenty years of experience advising on complex oil and gas, pipeline, power, and strategic infrastructure projects across Africa. He serves as Group Head, Legal & Company Secretary of Oilserv Group, one of Africa's foremost integrated energy infrastructure companies, where he provides strategic legal leadership across major upstream, midstream, EPC, gas processing, and energy transition projects, with responsibility for contract strategy, regulatory compliance, corporate governance, dispute management, project delivery support, and stakeholder engagement.

Humphrey has advised on some of Nigeria's most significant energy infrastructure developments, including large-scale gas transmission pipelines, upstream petroleum ventures, gas commercialisation initiatives, LNG-related infrastructure, and cross-border energy investments, with experience spanning the full project lifecycle from licensing, development, and financing through construction, operations, asset stewardship, and decommissioning. He is particularly recognised for his expertise in structuring complex service and contracting relationships, risk allocation frameworks, regulatory engagement, claims management, and developing legal strategies that enhance project performance, continuity, and commercial value creation.

Humphrey holds an LL.M in Petroleum Taxation and Finance from the University of Dundee, Scotland, where he specialised in petroleum fiscal systems and energy finance, an LL.B from the University of Nigeria, Nsukka, and a B.L. from the Nigerian Law School. He is a member of the Nigerian Bar Association (NBA), the Association of International Energy Negotiators (AIEN), the Energy Institute, and the Society of Petroleum Engineers (SPE), and regularly contributes to industry discourse on energy regulation, petroleum contracting, gas sector development, infrastructure governance, and sustainable investment frameworks.





Chinemerem Ikechi-Eshiet

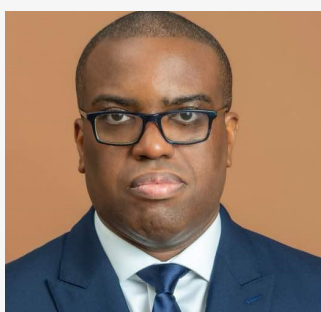
Company Secretary,
Pipeline Infrastructure Nigeria Limited

Speakers Bios

Chinemerem Ikechi-Eshiet is an accomplished legal practitioner with extensive experience in strategic legal counsel and business-focused solutions across diverse sectors. She earned her LL.B. from Madonna University, Okija, Anambra State, in 2010, attended the Nigerian Law School, Bwari, Abuja, and was called to the Nigerian Bar in November 2012, with a career spanning private practice and in-house counsel roles advising organisations on legal, commercial, regulatory, and operational matters. She holds an LL.M. from the University of East London, UK, and is an Associate Member of ICSAN and CI Arb (UK), Nigeria Branch, alongside active membership in the Nigerian Gas Association (NGA) and the Lawyers in Energy Network (LIEN).

In September 2022, she was appointed Company Secretary/Legal Adviser of Pipeline Infrastructure Nigeria Limited and its affiliates — Ocean Marine Solutions Limited, Delta Pacific Maritime Services Limited, and Gyro Air Limited — advising the boards, shareholders, and executive management on governance, high-value transactions, and regulatory matters. In August 2024, in recognition of her leadership and contributions, she was promoted to General Manager, Legal for the group, overseeing the legal function, enterprise-wide legal risk management, and corporate strategy execution.

Her experience spans the maritime, energy, aviation, security, infrastructure, real estate, and corporate services sectors, having negotiated, drafted, and managed high-value commercial agreements worth millions of dollars and naira. She is also a passionate advocate for women's advancement in the energy, maritime, and oil and gas industries, supporting this through her membership in the Women in Energy Network (WIEN) and similar associations dedicated to promoting female leadership and inclusion within the sector.



Uche Nwamara

General Counsel, Midwestern Oil and Gas Ltd

Speakers Bios

Uche Nwamara is a highly commercial legal expert with deep knowledge and proficiency in mergers and acquisitions, oil and gas law across the value chain, financings, including project finance, and private equity, with around 20 years' working experience across three continents. He currently serves as General Counsel and Company Secretary of Midwestern Oil and Gas Limited, where he supervises the legal and compliance functions of the Company.

Prior to joining Midwestern, Uche worked at First Hydrocarbon Nigeria (FHN), an Africa-focused upstream exploration and production company, for 13 years, the last 11 years as General Counsel and Company Secretary, with additional responsibility for the Company's commercial, supply chain, and compliance functions. While at FHN, he served as deal team lead for a management buyout of the Company from Afren Plc, a UK-listed energy company in administration, and helped lead a successful turnaround of the business that allowed investors, including management, to exit at a valuation multiple in excess of ten times their initial investment. Earlier in his career, following a stint in academia, Uche worked at leading law firms in the United States and the United Kingdom, most recently with the London office of Kirkland & Ellis LLP, where he gained significant experience in corporate law, advising private equity funds on buyout transactions across multiple jurisdictions and sectors.

Uche is a Summa Cum Laude (First Class Honours) graduate in History and Classics from Howard University in Washington, DC, and holds a Master's degree and a law degree (Juris Doctor) from Harvard University, where he was an editor of the International Law Journal and a recipient of the Harvard-Nigerian Fellowship for Distinguished African Scholars, a fellowship reserved for scholars of African origin at Harvard of particularly high achievement. He is an amateur violinist and pianist, enjoys reading historical fiction and doing word puzzles, and lives in Lagos, Nigeria, with his wife and two children.



Fortune Toma

Regulatory Affairs Lead,
Atom Energy Law Advisory

Speakers Bios

Fortune is an energy sustainability attorney and policy practitioner with extensive expertise in oil, gas, power, and extractives regulation. He is the Regulatory Affairs Lead at Atom Energy Law Advisory, where he provides legal and commercial advisory to both public and private sector clients across the energy value chain. In this capacity, he has supported the Nigerian Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Regulatory Authority (NMDPRA) in the drafting of over 20 gazetted and fully operational regulations and guidelines including the recently gazetted Midstream and Downstream Petroleum Operations Regulations of 2025.

As technical organiser for the NMDPRA General Counsel and Legal Advisers Forum 2026, he brings to the role hands-on experience in midstream and downstream policy dialogue, stakeholder convening, and industry advocacy, helping translate technical and regulatory discussions into actionable policy recommendations for Nigeria and the wider African market.

Fortune is also a Senior Legislative Aide to the Deputy Speaker of Nigeria's House of Representatives on Energy Policy and Legislative Affairs, where he provides technical support on legislative interventions, policy design, and oversight functions relating to the implementation of the Petroleum Industry Act and the development of Nigeria's entire energy ecosystem. He is a member of several industry organisations and bodies such as the Nigerian Gas Association, Lawyers in Energy Network, Nigerian Bar Association, International Bar Association, Nigerian Bar Association-Section on Business Law, Society of Petroleum Engineers (International), to mention a few.

NIGERIAN MIDSTREAM AND
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REGULATORY AUTHORITY

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NIGERIAN MIDSTREAM AND
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General Counsel and
Legal Advisers Forum

Theme:
Beyond Compliance.
Driving Regulatory Certainty and Investment
Confidence in Nigeria's Petroleum Sector

TECHNICAL ORGANISER

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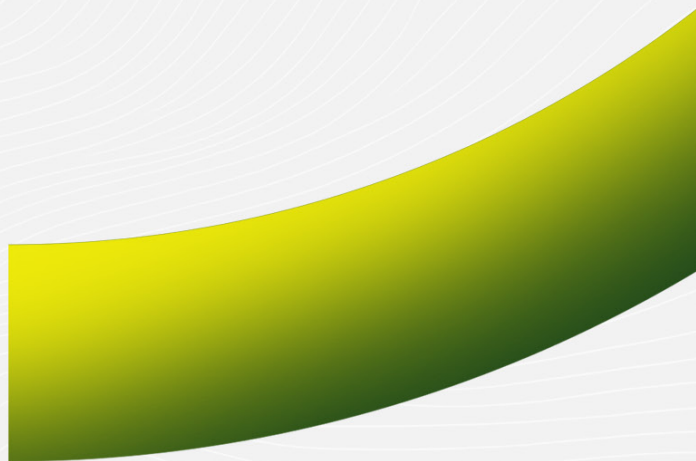
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